

REAL WORDS · REAL HEALING

What They Said

*200 things families
said that we're still
healing from — and
what we needed to
A GUIDED JOURNAL
hear instead*

I didn't write this book.

Thousands of strangers did. One question was asked online — “What’s *something a family member said that you’ll never fully forgive?*” — and people answered with things they had never said out loud.

I read every ^{xii}answer. I kept the words that staved. And

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01

The Favorite & the Forgotten

*For everyone who grew up
watching a sibling get the
softness they were never
given.*

“

My brother died suddenly. At the funeral, my mother turned to me and said it should have been me instead — in front of my children.

— shared by a daughter, 30s

WHAT YOU NEEDED TO
HEAR 4

You were never the

“

I was crying, and my mom turned to my brother with a smile — “Isn't she so dramatic?” My brother was the one who came over and hugged me.

— shared by a sister, 20s

WHAT YOU NEEDED TO
HEAR

5

Your feelings were

*“Their words
were a
prediction.
Not a
promise.”*

TAKE A BREATH BEFORE YOU
TURN THE PAGE

A letter you'll never send

*Say the thing you never got to
say. No one will read this but
you — so say it all.*

Dear
